SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT &
PEACE BUILDING INITIATIVES



2024 - 2028

STRATEGIC PLAN

MAY 2024

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FORWARD

The process of developing this strategy, which will guide Sustainable Development and Peace Building Initiatives (SYPD) for the next five years, has been phenomenal a process that has been very involving in terms of ensuring it has been an evidence-based process, all-inclusive from the board members, management, staff, and our partners, who have been very supportive of us over the years in our journey of supporting the most vulnerable communities in Somalia for over 19 years.

As we collaborate to achieve the most ambitious vision of "An African continent free of poverty, conflict, and disasters," we recognize that it will be a long journey with many ups and downs, but it is through this process that we will emerge much stronger, innovative, and informative.

As we embark on this journey to strengthen our local communities' capacities to respond to humanitarian needs and crises, it is critical to remember that it is not just about providing material assistance, but also about a more holistic approach that includes community sustenance, peace, and the inclusion of men, women, youths, and people living with disabilities in our evidence-based programmatic approaches. During this strategic period, we will be very deliberate in forming partnerships and networks with our partners, with the goal of achieving a greater impact in the communities we serve.

Finally, I'd like to express my heartfelt gratitude to the wonderful SYPD staff who worked tirelessly, with the support of the RAAGSAN consulting team, to create this very informative document that will carry our aspirations for the next five years.

Let us continue to travel together in the years ahead to help the most deserving members of our communities.

Many thanks.

Abdinoor Ibrahim Noor

Board Chair.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

The successful completion of the process of developing SYPD's 2024-2028 strategy would not have been possible without the exceptional teamwork of staff, management, and board guidance. The accomplishments we have made over the years have been the result of great teamwork, focus, professionalism, integrity, and a desire to serve the community even in the most difficult of times.

In light of the evolving landscape of the humanitarian response space in Somalia, marked by increased competition and resource scarcity, it has become imperative to adapt our strategy accordingly. This entails a thorough review of our operations, with a renewed focus on localization, evidence-based approaches, and fostering successful partnerships within various clusters such as protection, Gender Based Violence, and nutrition.

I extend my sincere gratitude to our esteemed partners, including Diakonie Katastrophenhilfe, Norwegian Refugee Council, and Welthungerhilfe, for their invaluable contributions and objective feedback during this process.

A special acknowledgment goes to the Raagsan Consulting Group, led by Badra Yusuf, Brian Kavuwa, the lead strategy consultant, and Mercy Chang'ach, the deputy team leader. Their expertise and dedication were instrumental in delivering a comprehensive strategy that will guide our operations for the next five years. I commend the highly participatory approach adopted by the Raagsan Consulting team, which ensured the inclusion of perspectives from all key stakeholders within and outside of SYPD.

To our esteemed board members, management team, and dedicated staff, your unwavering support and commitment are indispensable to the success of our organization.

As we transition to the implementation phase of the strategy, I urge each of us to actively engage and provide feedback, as it is through collective effort that we will overcome challenges and achieve our objectives.

Once again, I extend my heartfelt gratitude to everyone involved in this endeavor.

Thank you for your continued dedication and support.

Hassan Ali

Executive Director.

LIST OF ACRONYMS

AAP	Accountability to Affected People.
AWD	Acute Watery Diarrhea.
CCCM	Camp Coordination and Camp Management.
CFW	Cash for Work.
COVID-19	Novel Corona Virus 2019.
CSR	Community Social Responsibility.
CVA	Cash and Voucher Assistance.
DFID	The Department for International Development.
FAO	The Food and Agriculture Organization.
FSL	Food Security, Income and Livelihoods.
GDP	Gross Domestic Product.
HNO	Humanitarian Needs Overview.
HNO	Humanitarian Needs Overview.
IDPs	Internally Displaced Persons.
INGOs	International Non-Governmental Organizations.
MAM	Moderately Malnourished.
MoEWR	The Ministry of Energy and Wayer Resources.
MoH	Ministry of Health.
MTER	Medium Term Evaluation and Review.
NDC	Nationally Determined Contribution.
OCHA	United Nations Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs.
PSEA	Prevention of Sexual Exploitation and Abuse.
SAM	Severely Malnourished.
SDGs	Strategic Development Goals.
SWOT	Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities and Threats.
SYPD	Sustainable Development and Peace Building Initiatives.
ToC	Theory of Change.
UNICEF	United Nations Children's Fund.
WASH	Water, Sanitation and Hygiene.
WHO	World Health Organization.

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About Sustainable Development and Peacebuilding Initiatives (SYPD)

Who we are

Sustainable Development and Peace building initiatives (SYPD) is a non-profit and non-governmental organization operating across the Southwest, Jubaland, Hirshabelle, and Galmudug States in Somalia. SYPD headquarters is located in Mogadishu, Banadir region. As SYPD's commitment goes beyond providing immediate relief; it is deeply invested in fostering sustainable development and nurturing self-reliance within communities affected by conflict and climate shocks.

SYPD Journey

SYPD was established in response to the profound crisis that followed the collapse of the Somali government in 1991, which plunged the nation into a state of chronic insecurity, massive displacement, and a dire lack of access to fundamental human necessities such as food, water, and shelter. In the face of these daunting challenges, SYPD was formed on August 24th, 2004, with a clear mission: to alleviate human suffering by providing immediate relief and to foster long-term, sustainable development through solutions crafted from within the Somali context.

Founded by a local Somali national, SYPD was built on the principle that understanding and addressing the needs of Somali people require insights that are rooted in the lived experiences of the communities. This principle guided the organization to focus on engaging and empowering local populations, leveraging indigenous knowledge and practices to navigate the complexities of conflict resolution and peace-building. The establishment of SYPD was more than a mere reaction to crisis; it was a forward-looking venture, aiming to contribute to a future where Somalis could rebuild their communities with dignity and autonomy. From its inception, SYPD has been driven by the vision of creating a self-sustaining Somalia, equipped with the tools and capabilities to resolve internal conflicts and rebuild on the foundations of peace and collective well-being.

With over nineteen years of unwavering dedication, SYPD has evolved into a formidable force in humanitarian response and development within Somalia. Our journey is marked by a relentless pursuit of creating sustainable transformations, empowering communities to not just envision but to manifest long-term prosperity. Our success is deeply rooted in a collaborative approach, uniting communities, donors, partners, and government bodies in a shared mission to enhance the well-being of the Somali people.

As we look ahead, SYPD remains committed to innovating our strategies, strengthening our partnerships, and expanding our reach to ensure that every intervention leads to meaningful, lasting change. Our strategic plan is not just a roadmap for our future; it's a pledge to continue being a catalyst for hope, empowerment, and sustainable development.

Vision, Mission and Core Values

Vision

A nation where climate-resilient communities thrive, free from poverty, conflict, and disasters

Mission

To build climate-resilient communities in Somalia through the implementation of sustainable initiatives in environmental solutions, food security, livelihoods, stabilization, capacity strengthening and social inclusion, while prioritizing community-led and localized response mechanisms.

Core Values

Integrity & Professionalism: We are committed to conducting our operations in a transparent, honest and accountable manner.

Commitment: We are motivated by a steadfast commitment to working with vulnerable communities and helping them rebuild their lives.

Sustainability: We strive at developing programs and interventions that contribute to a beneficial impact in the lives of the communities we serve.

Inclusion & Innovatiness: We are obligated to be inclusive and creative when designing and implementing interventions that benefit the communities we serve, including marginalized groups and other stakeholders.

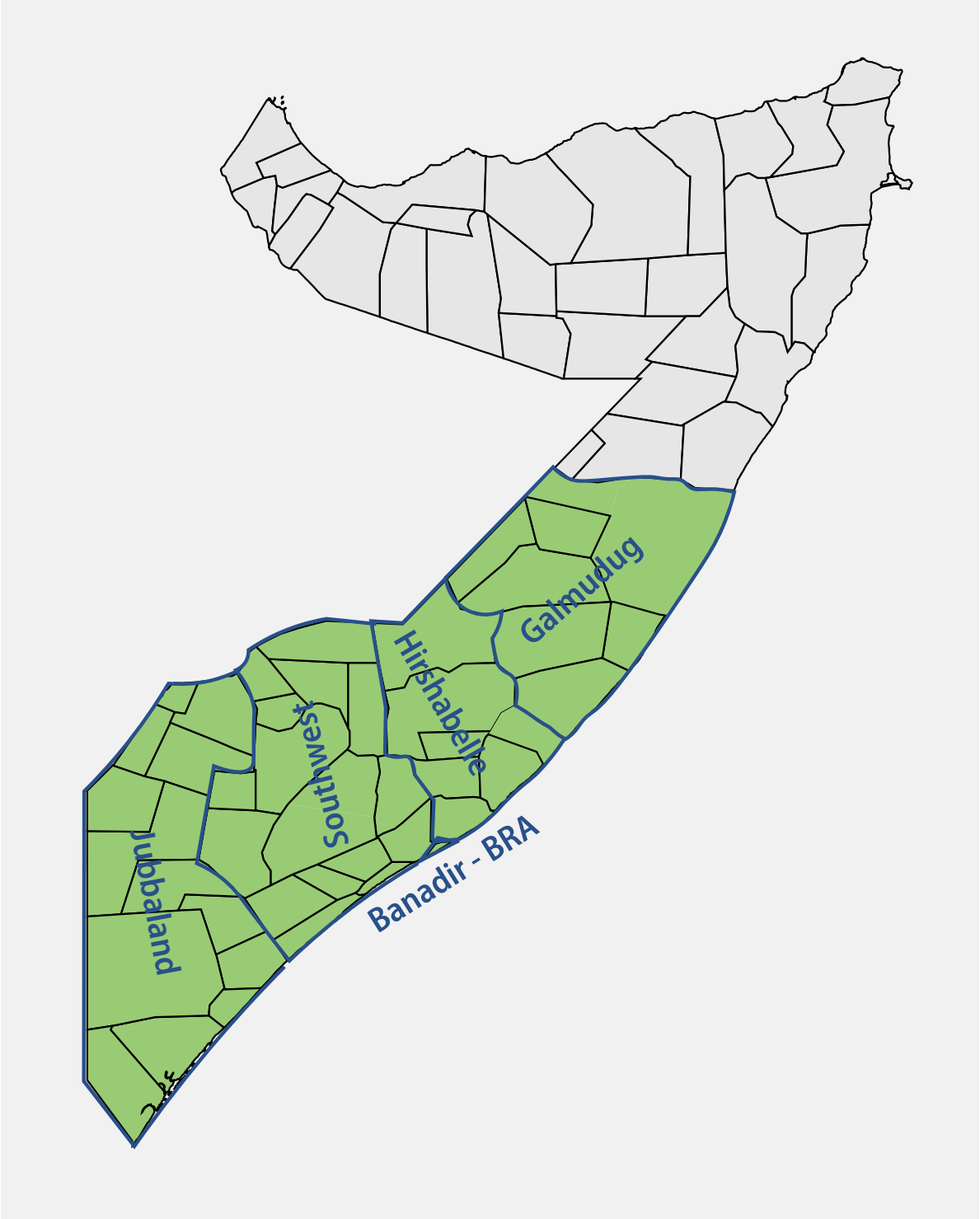
Do-No-Harm: We value life and believe that saving humanity is a noble cause.

Neutrality: We embrace impartiality as a cornerstone of our organization, fostering trust, respect, and equitable treatment for all.

| ***Figure 2**: Vision, Mission and Core Values*

**The core values will be acronymized as INCISD (Integrity & professionalism, Neutrality, Commitment, Inclusion & Innovativeness, Sustainability and Do-no-harm).*

SYPD Footprints



| ***Figure 3***: *Map of Somalia showing SYPD's areas of operation.*

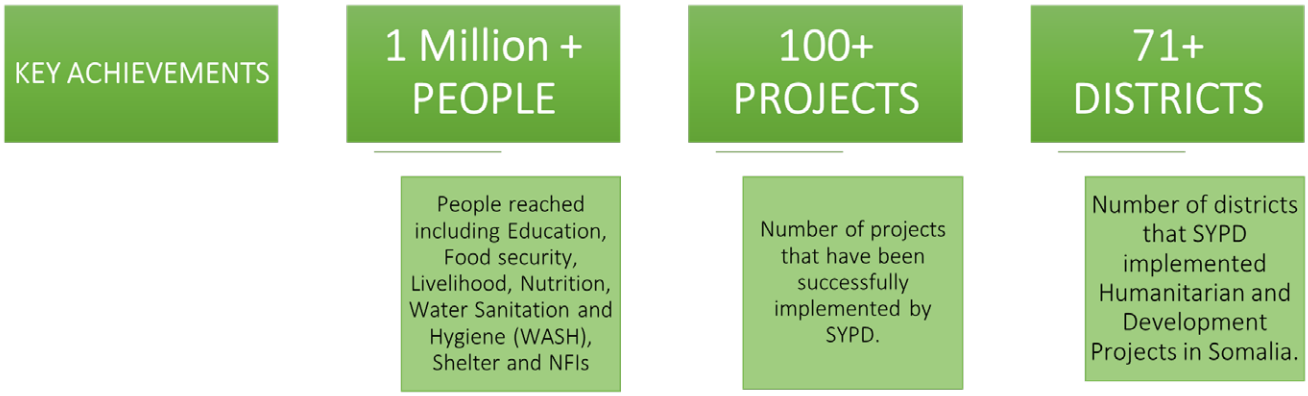
Strategic Pillars

As we embark on the forthcoming strategic period, SYPD delineates its pivotal areas of focus, with the acronym ***CHEFGS: a) Climate Resilience, Water Infrastructure and Ecosystem Rebuilding b) Health and Nutrition c) Economic Empowerment d) Food Security and agricultural Development; e) Gender Equality, Social Inclusion and Protection and f). Stabilization, Governance and Land Rights***. These domains have been meticulously selected to address the multifaceted challenges facing Somali communities, driving towards a holistic improvement in their quality of life. Central to our strategic approach is the commitment to ensuring that our interventions are locally led. This principle affirms our belief in the power of community ownership and the invaluable insights that local knowledge and leadership contribute to the success and sustainability of our programs.

Our key achievements so far

SYPD's footprint of impact is vast, marked by critical interventions across food security, WASH (Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene), shelter, and protection sectors. Our multi-sectoral projects have not only saved lives but have also improved access to basic services and restored living conditions for communities affected by conflict and climate shocks within the regions that SYPD is implementing programs in Somalia.

Key Highlights



| ***Figure 4:*** *SYPD Key Achievements*

Stories of Change



| ***Amina Adan*** *shopping for grocery at a kiosk at Jarati Camp in Baidoa*

A story of Resilience from Baidoa District, Somalia

Amina Adan Hassan, 55, took on the role of raising her six grandchildren after a stray bullet from clan conflict in her community killed one of her daughters. Amina supported her entire family as a farmer in Somalia's rural Bakool region with only a small plot of land and three cows. The milk from her cows provided a modest income for her growing family until the end of 2020, when the region experienced four consecutive "dry seasons" with little to no rainfall: water sources dried up, pastureland quickly vanished, and Amina lost two of her cows. With no means of support in a community facing famine, Amina made the difficult decision to leave her home in Bakool and travel over 150 kilometers to Baidoa city in the hopes of finding assistance for herself and her grandchildren. Amina settled at Jarati IDP Camp in Baidoa with only what she could carry; she and her family had joined a population of more than 600,000 Somalis who had been displaced by climate change-related disasters and conflict. Amina went days without eating and had to rely entirely on friends and neighbors for whatever assistance they could provide.

> *Amina qualified for cash transfers aimed at mitigating hunger and malnutrition through a cash-supported program targeting the most vulnerable residents of IDP camps in Baidoa. She was able to provide food, water, and clothing to her grandchildren after two rounds.*

"Today, my living standard is much better than before, my livelihood is better than before, and I will never forget SYPD [Diakonie Katastrophenhilfe' local partner organization] for their tremendous support." Amina stated.

| ***Figure 5****: A story of Resilience from Baidoa District, Somalia*

Strategy Development Methodology and Approach.

This strategy was developed through a consultative process which employed several methodologies which are highlighted below;

Stakeholder Analysis / Mapping | Effective strategic planning necessitates the identification and understanding of key stakeholders, both internal and external, who are affected by or have an impact on SYPD's work. During the early stages of strategy development, a stakeholder mapping tool was utilized to conduct stakeholder analysis and mapping, which helped SYPD prioritize stakeholder interests, anticipate concerns, and engage stakeholders in the planning process to gain support and alignment.

SWOT Analysis (Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, Threats) | We conducted a SWOT analysis, which is a fundamental method for identifying SYPD's internal strengths and weaknesses, as well as external opportunities and threats. This information was primarily derived from feedback gathered through a comprehensive questionnaire completed by staff, management, and the board. Furthermore, donors, who are recognized as critical stakeholders, provided valuable insights through key informant interviews, which played an important role in shaping this analysis.

Gap Analysis | We thoroughly examined the gap between SYPD's current situation and its desired future state, drawing on insights from our SWOT analysis, vision, mission, goals, and objectives. Furthermore, we conducted Key Informant Interviews (KIIs) with a variety of key stakeholders, and their feedback enabled us to identify strategic focal points for the upcoming planning period. Furthermore, using web-based research, we gained valuable insights into Somalia's humanitarian sector priorities by reviewing recent studies, government agency policies, and other implementing partner reports. This information has helped us prioritize strategic initiatives and allocate resources effectively.

Risk Assessment and Mitigation | Throughout the strategy development phase, we successfully identified potential risks and uncertainties that could impede the smooth implementation of our strategic plan. As a result, we developed comprehensive risk management strategies and contingency plans to mitigate these risks and navigate unexpected challenges with ease.

Communication and Engagement | The effective completion of this strategy would not have been possible without acknowledging the importance of the key stakeholders--staff, management, and the board. The draft strategy document was shared with the staff, management, and board for feedback during a validation meeting, ensuring that all feedback was well documented and incorporated into the draft for finalization. This is significant because it fosters a culture of transparency, collaboration, and accountability, which encourages buy-in and commitment to the plan's success.

Strategic Pillars and Objectives

Throughout the strategy creation phase, reaching out to key stakeholders for feedback was a critical milestone. Their valuable feedback greatly improved the refinement of our approach. During this strategic period, we will focus on the following strategic pillars and objectives:

Strategies	Activities	Outputs	Performance Indicators	Assumptions
Strategic Pillar 1: Climate Resilience, Water Infrastructure and Ecosystem Rebuilding Objective: To enhance climate resilience, improve water infrastructure, and promote ecosystem rebuilding initiatives to safeguard communities and ecosystems against the impacts of climate change and environmental degradation in Somalia for the next five years.				
Implementing climate-resilient practices at the community level to enhance adaptive capacity.	Conducting community workshops on climate-resilient agriculture and disaster risk reduction.	Increased adoption of climate-resilient agricultural practices by communities.	Percentage increase in the adoption of climate-resilient agricultural practices	Community participation and engagement will be high throughout the strategy implementation period.
Developing and rehabilitating water infrastructure for reliable and equitable access to safe water.	Rehabilitating and constructing water supply systems, including wells, boreholes, and rainwater harvesting facilities.	Improved access to safe water through the construction of water infrastructure.	Number of water infrastructure projects completed	Adequate funding and resources will be available for carrying out the planned activities.
Promoting restoration activities to rebuild degraded ecosystems and enhance biodiversity.	• Facilitating tree planting campaigns and mangrove rehabilitation initiatives. • Training communities in sustainable land management practices.	• Enhanced biodiversity and ecosystem services through ecosystem restoration efforts. • Strengthened capacity of communities in sustainable natural resource management.	• Increase in vegetation cover and biodiversity in restored ecosystems. • Percentage of communities trained in sustainable land management practices.	• Political stability and security conditions will remain conducive throughout the strategy implementation period. • Collaboration and coordination with relevant stakeholders will be effective.
Strategic Pillar 2: Health and Nutrition Objective: To enhance access to quality healthcare services and nutritional support for vulnerable communities in Somalia for the next five years.				
Improve and expand healthcare facilities and services to ensure better access for vulnerable communities	Renovating and equipping healthcare facilities in underserved areas	Improved infrastructure of healthcare facilities, including renovated buildings and upgraded medical equipment	Percentage increase in the number of functional healthcare facilities in target areas of Jubaland, Southwest, Hirbashelle & Galmudug	Adequate funding and resources will be available to support the implementation of healthcare and nutrition programs
Enhance the skills and knowledge of healthcare workers to provide quality care and nutritional support	Training healthcare staff on best practices in healthcare delivery and nutritional provision support.	Increased number of healthcare workers trained in providing quality care and nutritional support	Number of healthcare workers trained in nutrition and healthcare delivery	Collaboration and coordination with government agencies, local NGOs, and other key stakeholders will facilitate effective program delivery.
Collaborate with local and international organizations to leverage resources and expertise in healthcare provision and nutritional support	Distributing nutritional supplements and fortified foods to vulnerable populations, especially children and pregnant women	Enhanced nutritional status among vulnerable populations	Improvement in nutritional indicators such as stunting and wasting rates among children under five.	Supportive policies and regulations will facilitate the provision of quality healthcare services and nutritional support in Somalia
Strategic Pillar 3: Economic Empowerment Objective 3: To promote economic empowerment and create sustainable livelihood opportunities for vulnerable populations in Somalia for the next five years.				

Strategies	Activities	Outputs	Performance Indicators	Assumptions
Offer financial literacy training, access to microfinance, and mentorship to facilitate the establishment and growth of small businesses.	Organizing entrepreneurship workshops and business development trainings	Number of new businesses established by vulnerable populations.	Growth in income (in USD) levels among program participants	Collaboration and partnerships with government agencies, NGOs, and private sector stakeholders to leverage expertise and resources.
Facilitate access to markets and value chains to enable vulnerable populations to sell their products and services	• Providing access to microfinance loans and grants for business start-ups • Supporting agricultural cooperatives and community-based enterprises for collective marketing and bargaining power.	Increase in income levels among targeted beneficiaries.	Number of markets accessed and value chain linkages established.	Access to markets and favorable economic conditions for business growth and sustainability
Implement social safety nets and cash transfer programs to provide temporary assistance and build resilience against economic shocks.	Implementing cash transfer programs for vulnerable households to meet their basic needs and invest in income-generating activities.	Increased financial stability and improved living standards among vulnerable households due to access to cash transfers.	Percentage increase in household income levels among beneficiaries compared to baseline data	Vulnerable households will utilize cash transfers responsibly to meet their basic needs and invest in income-generating activities, leading to sustainable economic empowerment.
Strategic Pillar 4: Food security and Agricultural development Objective 4: To enhance food security and promote sustainable agricultural development in Somalia over the next five years				
Enhance agricultural infrastructure such as irrigation systems, storage facilities, and roads to increase productivity and market access for farmers	Rehabilitating and constructing irrigation systems and water harvesting structures	Increased agricultural productivity and crop yields	Percentage increase in crop yields and agricultural production compared to baseline data	Availability of funding and resources to support agricultural development initiatives
Provide training, education, and extension services to farmers on modern and sustainable agricultural practices, including crop diversification, soil conservation, and water management.	Conducting training workshops and demonstration farms on sustainable farming techniques.	Improved resilience of farmers to climate change and environmental shocks	Number of farmers trained in sustainable farming practices	Cooperation and collaboration among government agencies, NGOs, and other stakeholders in the agricultural sector
Ensure access to quality seeds, fertilizers, and other agricultural inputs, as well as financial resources and credit facilities for smallholder farmers	Distributing improved seeds, fertilizers, and agricultural tools to farmers	Expansion of market opportunities and income generation for farmers	Growth in income levels among the targeted farmers	Favorable weather conditions and minimal occurrences of natural disasters impacting agricultural production
Strategic Pillar 5: Gender Equality, Social Inclusion and Protection Objective 5: To advance gender equality, promote social inclusion, and support the strengthening of protection mechanisms in Somalia, ensuring the empowerment and inclusion of all marginalized groups, including women, youth, persons with disabilities, and other vulnerable populations for the next five years.				
Conduct training programs and awareness campaigns to promote gender equality, social inclusion, and protection rights among communities, government officials, and civil society organizations.	Organizing workshops and seminars on gender equality, social inclusion, and protection rights	Increased awareness and understanding of gender equality, social inclusion, and protection rights among stakeholders	Percentage increase in the number of individuals and organizations trained on gender equality, social inclusion, and protection rights	Availability of funding and resources to support capacity-building activities, advocacy campaigns, and community empowerment initiatives.

Strategies	Activities	Outputs	Performance Indicators	Assumptions
Advocate for the development and implementation of gender-responsive policies, laws, and programs, while providing technical support to institutions to strengthen protection mechanisms and ensure social inclusion	Conducting advocacy campaigns for the enactment and enforcement of gender-responsive policies and laws	Adoption and implementation of gender-responsive policies and programs at the national and local levels	Number of gender-responsive policies and programs adopted and implemented by government institutions	Collaboration and cooperation among government agencies, civil society organizations, and other stakeholders to advance gender equality, social inclusion, and protection rights.
Facilitate community-led initiatives that empower marginalized groups, including women, youth, persons with disabilities, and other vulnerable populations, to actively participate in decision-making processes and access resources and opportunities.	Establishing community-based support groups and platforms for marginalized groups to voice their concerns and access support services	Strengthened community networks and support systems for marginalized groups to access resources and services	Participation rates of marginalized groups in decision-making processes and community activities	Supportive political will and commitment from government leaders to prioritize the empowerment and inclusion of marginalized groups in national development agendas.
Strategic pillar 6: Stabilization, Governance and Land rights Objective 6: To contribute to the stabilization and improved governance by strengthening local institutions, promoting community-led initiatives for peacebuilding, enhancing accountability and transparency in governance processes, and advocating for the recognition and protection of land rights in Somalia for the next five years.				
Strengthen local institutions by providing training, technical assistance, and capacity-strengthening programs to improve their effectiveness in governance and service delivery.	Conducting training workshops and capacity-strengthening sessions for local government officials on governance principles, administrative processes, and service delivery.	Enhanced capacity and skills of local institutions in governance and service delivery.	Percentage increase in the capacity and effectiveness of local institutions, measured through performance assessments and stakeholder feedback.	Availability of funding and resources to support capacity-building activities, peacebuilding initiatives, and advocacy campaigns.
Facilitate community-led peacebuilding initiatives by promoting dialogue, reconciliation, and conflict resolution mechanisms at the grassroots level.	Facilitating community dialogues, peace forums, and conflict resolution workshops to address underlying grievances and promote reconciliation among conflicting parties.	Strengthened social cohesion, trust, and conflict resolution mechanisms within communities.	Reduction in the frequency and intensity of conflicts and violence within targeted communities, as indicated by conflict monitoring data and community surveys.	Cooperation and collaboration among government institutions, CSOs and community leaders to implement stabilization and governance programs effectively.
Advocate for policies and practices that promote accountability, transparency, and good governance at both the local and national levels through engagement with government institutions and civil society.	Organizing advocacy campaigns, policy dialogues, and public forums to raise awareness about the importance of accountability, transparency, and citizen participation in governance processes.	Increased awareness and engagement of citizens and stakeholders in promoting accountability and transparency in governance processes.	Level of citizen engagement and participation in governance processes, measured by indicators such as voter turnout, participation in public consultations, and feedback mechanisms.	Supportive political environment and commitment from key stakeholders to prioritize governance reforms, peacebuilding efforts, and transparency initiatives in Somalia.

Strategies	Activities	Outputs	Performance Indicators	Assumptions
Empowering Communities through Secure Land and Property Rights.	Provide education on land tenure systems, land registration processes, and mechanisms for resolving land disputes. Empower community members, especially women and marginalized groups, with knowledge and skills to assert their land rights and participate in decision-making processes. Facilitate participatory land use planning processes involving community members, local authorities, and other stakeholders.	Development of community land use plans reflecting the aspirations, priorities, and needs of local stakeholders. Increased collaboration and cooperation among community members, local authorities, and other stakeholders in land use decision-making processes. Enhanced understanding of sustainable land management practices and conservation measures to protect natural resources and ecosystems.	Percentage increase in community members' knowledge and understanding of land tenure systems and registration processes. Number of women and marginalized individuals who actively engage in land-related decision-making processes within their communities. Level of community participation in land use planning processes.	Local authorities will be supportive of participatory land use planning processes and are willing to collaborate with community members and other stakeholders in decision-making. Sufficient resources and expertise will be available to provide adequate training and support to community members in understanding and asserting their land rights, and in engaging in participatory planning processes.

Crosscutting Strategies

In this strategic period, we have identified and prioritized three key strategies that will guide all aspects of our operations, forming the pillar of our efforts to realize the profound impact we envision over the next five years.

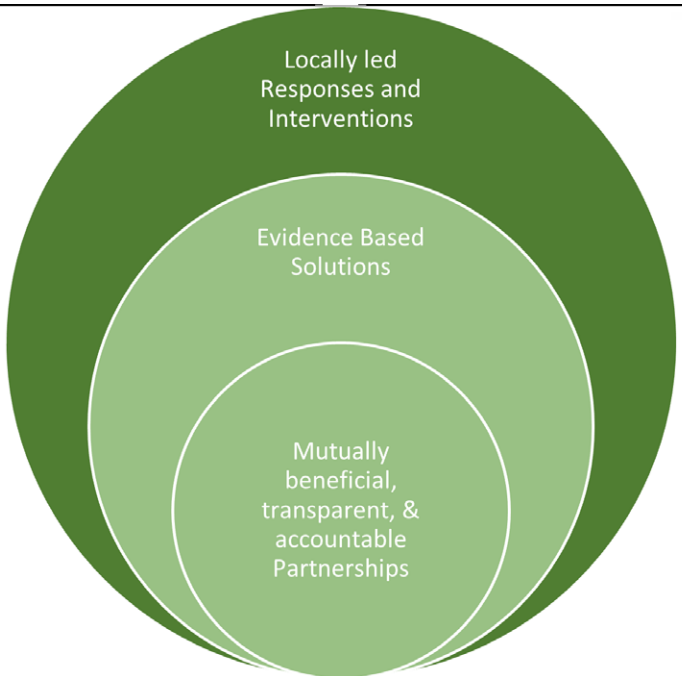


Figure 6: Cross-cutting strategies

Localization	We will prioritize and promote locally led responses by co-creating interventions with local communities and forming alliances with other local organizations, community groups, government agencies, and international non-governmental organizations (NGOs) to leverage collective strengths, share resources, and collaborate efforts. SYPD can also encourage capacity sharing by sharing knowledge, expertise, and best practices with other local actors and humanitarian stakeholders, cultivating a culture of learning and collaboration.
Generation of evidence and sharing	Evidence is crucial for measuring progress and demonstrating the impact of interventions and programs in communities over the next five years. SYPD will use storytelling techniques to communicate the impact of humanitarian interventions and engage stakeholders in meaningful dialogue, as well as involve affected communities in evidence generation and sharing processes through participatory approaches, and organize workshops, conferences, and peer-learning events to disseminate evidence, share experiences, and promote collaboration.
Partnerships	For the next five years, this strategy will center on forming partnerships. We aim to promote a culture of learning, innovation, and continuous improvement in order to improve collaboration and maximize impact over time. We will also use feedback mechanisms, surveys, and performance indicators to evaluate the partnership's effectiveness, identify areas for improvement, and establish communication, collaboration, and coordination platforms such as regular meetings, workshops, and joint planning sessions.

Table 2: ***Cross Cutting Strategies***

Operational Context

We aim to bolster our competitive advantage by improving our understanding of our value proposition. During this strategic period, SYPD will strengthen its value proposition by focusing on program beneficiaries first and implementing participatory approaches that involve them in decision-making, program design, and implementation. We will also foster innovation and adaptability in order to effectively respond to changing humanitarian challenges and opportunities by cultivating a culture of learning and continuous improvement. In addition, we will advocate for policy reforms, resource allocation, and systemic changes at the local, national, and international levels to address the root causes of Somalia's humanitarian challenges.

Conducting an operational analysis was critical for analyzing our differentiators, vulnerability points, identifying untapped opportunities, and eliminating threats that may prevent us from achieving our objectives.

Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, and Threats (SWOT).

Our SWOT analysis takes into account both internal and external factors that must be addressed to achieve our projected performance.

Strengths	Weaknesses
▪ Existence of organizational policies, manuals, and guidelines that inform the internal business processes. ▪ Highly experienced multisectoral team of staff. ▪ Great relations with the existing partners including donors, government agencies, and peer organizations. ▪ Excellence in documentation ▪ Leading organization in implementing water and food security projects in the South and central regions of Somalia.	▪ Absence or lack of an organizational strategy developed on time. ▪ Absence of strategic mid-term and end-term review which would have informed the development of the strategy for the next strategic period. ▪ Key staff turnover due to lack of overhead costs and active projects. ▪ Low social media presence affecting SYPD's visibility. ▪ Absence of a merit-based performance management system. ▪ Dependency on a limited number of funding sources.
Opportunities	**Threats**
▪ The localization agenda. ▪ The blue economy. ▪ Economic empowerment as a new strategic area. ▪ Programmatic opportunity in Research and Development, Governance, and Democracy.	▪ Increasingly competitive funding landscape in Somalia. ▪ Insecurity in Somalia ▪ Funding shortages in the humanitarian space. ▪ Bureaucratic challenges from the government or other stakeholders. ▪ Terror groups and clan conflicts. ▪ Conflicts of interest from the INGOs, and geopolitics impact like the ongoing conflict in Ukraine and current Red Sea tensions which practically affect commodity prices. ▪ Frequent leadership changes among federal member states as well as the federal government itself.

| Table 3: *SWOT Analysis*

Relevant Policies, Studies and Guidelines Analysis

We meticulously track the environment in which we work, as well as the policies, guidelines, and technical guidance notes issued by key stakeholders, policy bodies, and other humanitarian sector players. As a result, we have taken the time to review and highlight some of the various policies and guidance notes that may affect or influence our work in the following strategic period, which are briefly highlighted below:

Policy/ Guidance notes	Relevant details to SYPD
Somalia National Development Plan 2020-2024	**Conflict and Violence**: Conflict in Somalia is complex and in the eyes of many observers has tended to define the country's recent history. Most conflicts revolve around scarce resource availability and access, which are exacerbated by exogenous shocks such as droughts and other climate-related shocks[1]. **Social protection**: The provision of social protection in Somalia is very low compared to its neighboring countries. This is due to financial constraints as well as a lack of access in rural areas because of security. Both Ethiopia & Kenya have established social protection schemes to provide a system of buttressing shocks primarily related to natural disasters. Ethiopia runs the Productive Safety Nets Program, one focus area of social protection programs aimed at a rapid response targeted at the poorest in times of natural disaster, including public works projects. Building resilience, reducing poverty, and transitioning from aid dependency are key tenets of Somalia's national development. The need for social protection schemes is demonstrated in that 66 percent of Somalis reported experiencing at least one shock in the previous year (Wave 2-SHFS, 2018), with drought accounting for 50 percent of these shocks, alongside a loss of livestock, crop, or water. **Gender and Social Exclusion**: The interventions are designed to target the provision of health, education, and protection services to the most disadvantaged members of society, with special emphasis on women, infants, children, and youth. Youth comprise 70 percent of the population, the youth is the backbone of Somalia's future for economic and social development. However, the highest portion of unemployment in the country falls under this demographic. The National Youth Policy focuses on those whose ages range between 15 and 40 as the stage in life containing key transitions to different statuses and environments: childhood to adulthood, school to work, and dependence to independence[2]. **Resilience**: Resilience can be strengthened through the sustainable delivery of essential services along with social protection in times of shocks. However, as the Social Protection Policy states, it is critical to establish clearly defined, long-term, predictable programs that will begin to provide a safety net for highly vulnerable individuals while contributing to the broader well-being and resilience of their constituent households[3]. **Blue economy**: A strong blue economy is expected to increase employment for youth and make available entrepreneurial opportunities for new enterprises, attract international investment, and inject new technologies into the sector. In this regard, the Somalia Ministry of Youth has underscored that poverty in Somalia is closely correlated with the high rate of youth unemployment.[4] Rather than contributing to the welfare of citizens, the blue economy of Somalia has become an idle resource and a contributor to insecurity and illegal activity. The Somali Federal Ministry of Fisheries and Marine Resources outlined in its Somali Fisheries Development Framework 2018–2020 of NDP8, the vital needs to revitalize the Somali blue economy sector **National Stabilization Strategy (NSS)**: The overall goal of NSS will be to improve stability in Somalia by delivering tangible results that strengthen cohesion within communities and between communities and their government. The purpose of the strategy is to support a combination of peace and state-building interventions and prevent violence through the following efforts: 1). Engage communities in dialogue to address their legitimate grievances and develop confidence building measures, 2). Expand socio-economic opportunities to build resilient communities and reduce poverty, 3. Promote transparency and inclusivity to increase government legitimacy, and 4). Provide justice and security services to all groups to extend legitimate state authority[5].

1 ACLED (2018)
2 Federal Government of Somalia, 2019, "National Employment Policy," Ministry of Labor and Social Affairs,
3 Federal Government of Somalia, 2019, "National Social Protection Policy," Ministry of Labor and Social Affairs,
4 Somali Ministry of Youth and Sports, "THE NATIONAL YOUTH POLICY OF THE FEDERAL GOVERNMENT OF SOMALIA"
5 Federal Government of Somalia, Ministry of Interior, Federal Affairs and Reconciliation and Federal Member States, Stabili

Humanitarian Response Plan-Somalia, 2023	The 2023 Somalia Humanitarian Response Plan (HRP) is informed by the robust intersectoral analysis of the 2023 Humanitarian Needs Overview (HNO) which identifies 8.25 million people in need of humanitarian assistance in Somalia. The HRP requires $ 2.6 billion to assist 7.6 million vulnerable people across the whole country representing around 90 per cent of the people in need. This is in line with the IASC Humanitarian system-wide scale-up that came into effect in August 2022 and the HCT's strategic direction to scaleup response both in magnitude and quality of response to avert the prolonged consecutive drought and risk of Famine. The targeting is informed by the magnitude and severity of the needs identified in the HNO, the partners' capacity to scale up and the operating environment, including access. The 7.6 million people targeted to receive humanitarian assistance in 2023 include: 1). 739,800 newly displaced people (those displaced within the past 12 months), 2). 1.1 million protracted IDPs (those displaced for more than 12 months), 3). 3.2 million shock-affected urban people, 4). 4.4 million shock-affected rural people & 5). 51,300 refugees, asylum seekers and returnees. The HRP also outlines how ***protection mainstreaming, localisation, gender, age and disability, Accountability to Affected Populations (AAP), and the Prevention of Sexual Exploitation and Abuse (PSEA)*** are integrated into specific cluster plans and will be strengthened across the response[6].
Development Initiatives: Supporting longer term development in crises at the nexus Lessons from Somalia, February 2021.	Localized responses should be scaled up through financing and capacity building for Somali NGOs, with the inclusion of private sector actors. Local and national NGOs are well established in Somalia, having played a key role in humanitarian responses since the drought in 2011 and in advocacy on the localisation agenda. The establishment of NGO consortia, for example through BRCiS, SomReP and RE-INTEG, and the move to increase the participation of Somali NGOs is positive. However, to further localisation commitments made at the World Humanitarian Summit, a change in the way that donors' approach and finance partnerships with local NGOs is needed. Somali NGOs should be included in consortia from the outset and involved in decision-making and management structures.
Federal Government of Somalia-WASH Sector Strategic Plan, 2019—2023	Somalia is both a water scarce country and a country with collapsed infrastructure as a result of prolonged civil war compounded with limited sector governance and low availability of skilled individuals. According to WHO-UNICEF Joint Monitoring Program (JMP) 2017- SDG launch report, access to piped water stands at 19% nationally; whereas, access to improved water sources stands at 40% nationally. Access to basic sanitation stands at 16%, with 11% of population using shared facilities and 34% unimproved sanitation facilities. Open defecation rate stands at 39% nationally with 7% in urban areas and 60% in rural defect in the open. The management of WASH programs are highly centralized. Management structures, procedures and tools for technical support at all levels are either inadequate or absent. There is a lack of appropriate information on the WASH sector operations to enable objective decision making for the management and for policy makers. It is difficult to have proper record of the technical and professional staff available in the WASH sector. In addition, there are no harmonized and coordinated legal, regulatory and policy frameworks. The policies and acts in place remain draft for long in all institutions and are inconsistent with no monitoring and evaluation frameworks to measure the progress on the implementation of the policies.[7]

6 Humanitarian Response Plan, Somalia,2023.

7 Federal Government of Somalia-WASH Sector Strategic Plan, 2019—2023

UNDP Somalia Gender Equality Strategy (2023-2026).	Climate and human induced shocks, such as droughts, floods, locusts, leading to the increase of the movement of Internally Displaced Persons (IDPs) and seriously affect women. COVID-19 pandemic, exacerbated by poor health infrastructure, and fragilities in the health management system, led to an aggravation of the existing challenges (SGBV, food insecurity and loss of livelihood). The ongoing drought is expected to render half the population food insecure by mid-2023 and place the country at increased risk of famine.[8]
Somalia Drought Impact & Needs Assessment, Volume II Sector Reports.	The latest in a cycle of devastating protracted dry spells over the last 25 years, the current drought and the resulting humanitarian emergency have worsened existing humanitarian and development challenges in Somalia. Decades of insecurity, political instability, drought and food insecurity have disrupted desperately needed services, devastated human capital and physical infrastructure, and contributed to systematic impoverishment and displacement of the population. The ongoing 2016-17 drought has plunged the majority of the population into food insecurity. At the peak of the drought, an estimated 6.7 million people – more than half of the population – were acutely food insecure and in need of humanitarian assistance.1 The below average rainfall has resulted in a significant depletion of water resources for agricultural consumption and livestock body conditions have deteriorated substantially. Food insecurity and scarcity of drinking water, coupled with displacement, has contributed to a stark rise in malnutrition and water-borne disease. Agro-pastoralists, estimated at 22.8 percent of the total population, are mostly poor, dependent on either/both settled crop production and livestock rearing, and to a lesser extent on forestry products. Average holdings of banana, lemon, grapefruit and papaya plantations are 20 ha, 14 ha, 10 ha, and 0.5 ha, respectively. Most cereal and sesame production, however, is undertaken by small-scale farmers with land holdings between 2 ha and 5 ha, and most other crop production is undertaken by subsistence farmers with an average of only 0.2–3 ha of land. According to the FAO, the smallholder-farming sub-sector accounts overall for 80 percent of total crop output and 70 percent of marketed agricultural produce[9].
Ministry of Agriculture and Irrigation, Draft National Irrigation Policy-2019	The agriculture sector is the backbone of the Somali economy. Agriculture is the dominant sector of the Somalia economy and its performance is the major determinant of overall GDP growth rate. The agricultural sector has a crucial role in ensuring food security, job creation, income generation, and foreign exchange earnings. Indeed, about 70% of the country's population lives in rural areas and derives its livelihood from agriculture and related activities. The agriculture sector is the key to addressing poverty and food insecurity. Some 3 million hectares are cultivable, almost 2.3 million hectares produces or could produce crops under rainfed conditions, and 700,000 hectares could produce crops under pump or recession-controlled irrigation, mainly along the two main rivers, the Shabelle and the Juba. It is important to highlight that almost two-thirds of cultivable lands, both rainfed and irrigated, is in the fertile areas along and between the two major rivers in the southern regions.

8 UNDP Somalia Gender Equality Strategy, (2023-2026).
9 Somalia Drought Impact & Needs Assessment, Volume II Sector Reports.

South West State of Somalia, Drought Intervention and Recovery Plan, October 2017 to March 2019-Supported By SOMREP And The European Union.	**Health**: OCHA Situation Report No. 14 (20th to 27th June 2017) noted that people displaced by drought remain acutely vulnerable to the spread of the AWD/cholera and other communicable diseases, due to limited access to safe water, poor sanitation and hygiene conditions in the settlements. The on-going measles outbreak is reported to be the worst in four years; with over 17,200 suspected cases of which were children under 5 years, reported between January and July 2017. With regard to AWD/Cholera, earlier assessments done by other partners identified the following gaps in the region: funding shortfall that continues to hamper delivery of life-saving health services to most vulnerable people including IDPs in Baidoa; inaccessibility of some areas as a result of insecurity is affecting delivery of basic health services to affected communities. According to MOH/WHO, the number of AWD/cholera cases and deaths in accessible areas is 4 times the number of cases and deaths that are inaccessible areas. There is an urgent need for life-saving medical supplies to health facilities, especially in drought and AWD/Cholera-affected areas; and additional Cholera Treatment Centres are needed in Bay and Bakool for infected populations[10]. Nutrition: The nutrition situation in SWS has also continued to deteriorate partly due to food insecurity, morbidity and lack of milk in many households. According to Somalia Post Gu Seasonal Food Security and Nutrition Assessment (5th September 2017), Lower Shabelle region had a higher malnutrition prevalence with approximately 31,200 children under the age of five being acutely malnourished in June and July 2017. This includes 24, 200 moderately malnourished (MAM) and 7,000 severely malnourished (SAM) children[11].
National Drought Plan for Somalia, December, 2020	Impacts of **climate-induced disasters** on **livelihoods and food security** are generally experienced in Somalia through the occurrence of droughts and floods. Droughts and floods are certainly the two most stressful elements of climate crisis and have been emphasized as major drivers of food insecurity, hunger, undernourishment, famine, and population displacement. Droughts also often create conflicts among pastoral communities in search of scarce grazing resources for their livestock as well as between pastoralists and farmers as the latter attempt to protect their farms from others. Droughts occurred almost every year for the last twenty years. In the vulnerable pastoral and agropastoral communities of Somalia, who form the majority of the population, even one dry year spills disaster. When drought extends to a second year, the impact can be a devastating loss of life and famine[12]. When drought strikes, food insecurity increases, primarily through loss or reduction in crop production, death of livestock or declining milk and meat production, as well as greater and widespread drinking water shortage. By cutting agricultural production to extremely low levels, droughts dramatically raise essential food prices such as grains, beans, vegetables and fruits, meat and milk leading to serious food insecurity, undernourishment, and even starvation and famine. Women and children are disproportionately affected by the impacts of drought as they are more vulnerable to droughts and have less capacity to access food because of underlying social structures that have yet to develop a more equitable society. Thus, most fatalities and undernourished individuals are seen in **children** and **women** during severe drought episodes. The importance of taking these two social groups into serious consideration and inclusion in any drought management strategy and drought plan cannot be overemphasized[13].

10 Somalia Drought Impact & Needs Assessment, Volume II Sector Reports.
11 South West State of Somalia, Drought Intervention and Recovery Plan, October 2017 to March 2019-Supported by SOMREP & the European Union.
12 National Drought Plan for Somalia, December, 2020
13 National Drought Plan for Somalia, December, 2020

Somalia Livestock Sector Development Strategy, 2019	Every nomadic household owns at least one goat, sheep, camel, donkey, cattle or chicken, and they tend to own more than non-nomadic households (World Bank 2019). Every nomadic household owns some type livestock, compared to 53 percent of the rural households, 35 percent of IDPs in settlements, 23 percent in other urban areas and 19 percent in Mogadishu. Chickens are the only type of livestock owned by a higher share of rural (including agro-pastoral) than of nomadic households; 18 vs. 11 percent respectively (Figure 2.6a, pg 13). Among owners, nomadic households also own a larger number of livestock than non-nomadic households; nearly twice for cattle, sheep, goat and camels (Figure 2.6b, pg 13). Wealth in the form of livestock represents an advantage against other populations living in IDP settlements, urban and rural areas. Yet, relying primarily on livelihood based on livestock makes them more vulnerable to climate-related shocks. Though information on households' herd numbers and composition over time remains weak and preliminary, recent reports indicate that in many areas' pastoralists have become poorer, with more households shifting from middle to poor wealth groups and from poor to very poor wealth groups (Bishop, et al., 2008; World Bank 2019). Recurrent drought episodes, often combined with insecurity, have led to pastoralists losing large numbers of animals and many migrating to (peri) urban areas. For pastoralists, loss of animals is closely related to destitution and marginalization from community life.
National Disaster Management Policy, Somalia-2017	The humanitarian crisis in Somalia is among the most complex protracted emergencies in the world. Somalia is highly vulnerable to disasters – the country ranks 15th on the DFID list among the developing countries at high disaster risk. The 2011 drought resulted in 260,000 deaths in Somalia. In the past decade, droughts rendered 870,000 people food insecure and an additional 2.3 million – nearly a fifth of the population - vulnerable to food insecurity. According to the World Bank's Natural Hotspots Study, 43% of Somalia's land area is exposed to flooding and drought which expose 54% of the population to extreme weather and natural risks. Policies and protocols to deal with disasters and vulnerability are almost non-existent as state apparatus is only just beginning to evolve. This is where the role of the Government ought to come in – in developing a framework that ensures that disasters are recognized as deep rooted and longer-term problems that must be planned for, with consequences that can be reduced and mitigated when appropriate measures are taken[14].

14 National Disaster Management Policy, Somalia-2017

National Environmental Policy, Somalia-2019	Sustainable management of natural resources is non-existent. Rapid deforestation across the country has created the conditions for desertification. Charcoal and firewood remain the main sources of energy both in urban and rural areas. Moreover, illegal charcoal export from the country continues unabated despite a ban by UN Security Council Resolution 2036 (2012) and the Somali government. According to United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) estimates, 8.2 million trees were cut down for charcoal in Somalia between 2011 and 2017. As a result, the forests in Somalia have been depleted to such an extent that the livelihood of the population has been severely impacted. Deforestation of the country led to land degradation, food insecurity and vulnerability to flooding and drought. A National Charcoal Policy is now in place to counter deforestation. Environmental degradation is a major causal factor in enhancing and perpetuating poverty, particularly among the rural poor, when such degradation impacts soil fertility, quantity and quality of water, air quality, forests and wildlife. Equally, pastures and rivers are being unsustainably exploited, diminishing economic opportunities they could provide and diminishing essential resources required by the agricultural sector to manage times of crisis or stress. The poor are more vulnerable to loss of resilience in ecosystems. Large reductions in resilience may mean that the ecosystems, on which livelihoods are based, break down, causing distress. The loss of the environmental resource base can result in certain groups of people being made destitute. Poverty itself can accentuate environmental degradation given that environmental resources such as charcoal are a source of income. Poverty and environmental degradation are also reinforced by, and linked to population growth, which in turn, depends on a complex interaction of diverse causal factors and stages of development[15].

15 National Environmental Policy, Somalia-2019

Post Flood Solutions Assessment, Beledweyne, Somalia- Durable Solutions Secretariat Federal Government of Somalia, 2020.	**Sector Impact-Housing and Human Settlement** The flood enormously damaged the already poor conditions of housing in Beledweyne. Over 70 percent of the city and river basin areas were flooded and over period of one month leaving many still displaced and others with badly damaged and destroyed houses to go back. An estimated 45,500 households were displaced by early November 2019 flooding. Basic shelter needs of the flood-affected population still exist and many families are unable to rehabilitate their homes in terms of cost or fear of future flooding in the near As a result of the poor urban settlement and land use planning the flood created land disputes in the area. There are no effective enforcement of the existing Housing, Land and Property regulations to protect and safeguard the assets and properties of flood affected families. Those with especial needs, elderly and children are impacted the most and did not receive the attention and care needed during flood emergency and response. **Health and Nutrition** Flood created logistical challenges made impossible to get essential medical and nutrition supplies to the flood affected people in Beledweyne during crisis, compromising emergency responding institutions, agencies and private health services capacity and quality of services. Acute malnutrition increased putting at risk more children, pregnant women and elderly persons in the flood-affected areas. Education 33,701 school children in 104 schools affected by floods in Beledweyne, Berdale, Hudur, Marka and districts in Gedo1. Districts schools were closed even after the flooding in October 2019, keeping all school age children out of school and without or minimum recreational activities. Most of already scarce resources are directed to flood emergency response meaning less resource to education and rehabilitation of flood-affected schools[16].

16 Post Flood Solutions Assessment, Beledweyne, Somalia- Durable Solutions Secretariat Federal Government of Somalia, 2020.

Somalia Climate Change Policy, 2021	As a highly vulnerable country, adaptation and building resilience to climate change is the country's highest priority. Through the adaptation contribution of the NDC, Somalia aims to enhance adaptive capacity, strengthen resilience and reduce vulnerability to climate change through mainstreaming climate adaptation to into sustainable development. Gender Mainstreaming: Climate Change has exacerbated gender inequality in Somalia, with women and children affected more by climate change effects due to lack of access and control of critical resources, biased labor division and absence from decision making processes from household to the National level. For example, reports indicate that 70-80% of those in IDPs and refugee camps are women, who are exposed to gender-based violence. On the other hand, women and youth can act as agents of change and play a key role in supporting the transition towards low emissions and climate resilient development in Somalia. There are critical gender issues across sectors and hence the promotion of gender equality is critical for effective climate adaptation and mitigation in Somalia. The country needs to be supported to undertake comprehensive and in-depth gender analysis to inform gender integration across climate adaptation and mitigation sectors. There is a need to build capacities of key stakeholders at all levels including decision-makers on mainstreaming gender in climate actions. Similarly, there is a need for enhanced capacity building of various institutions and strengthening policy and legislative frameworks to support Somalia enhance its adaptive capacities to climate change. In particular, the country requires support to enhance capacities to access multilateral and bilateral climate finance sources, address barriers and enhance private sector investments and establish effective institutional mechanisms to enhance mobilization and effective utilization of climate finance
Somalia National Food Policy, 2020	**Agriculture**: The agriculture sector is the major contributor to food security as it provides between 30-50% of the country's cereal requirements from domestic production. According to FAO, smallholder farming accounts for 80 per cent of total crop output and 70 per cent of marketed agricultural produce. More than 60% of cereal and grain requirement of the country is imported from the outside. Therefore, the agriculture sector development should be central to any future national and international interventions aimed at addressing the food and nutrition insecurity in Somalia as well as tackling the widespread poverty which is the prime driver of resource based social conflicts. **Livestock**: The livestock sector is the largest sector of the economy, the largest employer in rural areas with nomadic cultures, and the main driver of exports. The Livestock sector is the source of livelihood for pastoralists, contributes to Government revenues, and provides employment to a wide range of professionals and other service providers. According to NDP 2017-2019, the sector provides job opportunities for over 55% of the total labor force, plus indirect employment for another large segment of the labor force along the livestock value chains. **Fisheries**: Fisheries sector Somalia has the longest coastline of continental Africa, approximately 3,333 km extending from the western passage of the Gulf of Aden to the Indian Ocean up to the border with Kenya. Fishing industry in Somalia has a potential to contribute to Somalia's economic development and poverty reduction[17].

17 Somalia National food policy, 2020.

Somalia National Water Resource Strategy, 2021 - 2025	Apart from the people living along the Juba and Shabelle Rivers, the Somali population depends on **groundwater for domestic water supply, livestock, and small-scale irrigation.** The main groundwater sources of Somalia are boreholes, shallow wells, and springs. Boreholes are the most strategic water sources in Somalia, as a majority have water throughout the year and provide water when other sources dry out[18]. Over 47% of the Somali population does not have access to safe water, sanitation and hygiene (WASH) services (Reliefweb, 2020), More than two million people need preventive WASH actions, including safe drinking water, water treatment, safe excreta disposal, and hygiene promotion (Reliefweb, 2020). The focus should be given to sustainable water services and to water use productivity in agriculture and livestock. In addition to this, the regulation of water use is a critical mechanism towards driving water efficiencies which will assist in balancing out supply and demand issues. Thus, there is a need for water sensitive agricultural practices that can achieve food and nutrition security outcomes for improved human health and well-being (Mabhaudhi, Chibarabada, & Modi, 2016).
Somalia: Economics of Water Report by Chantal Richey, Philip Schuler, and Shyam K.C., 2021.	Inequality along income, gender, spatial, and other dimensions is critical to understanding water usage in Somalia. Inequalities in access to water supplies and sanitation between rural and urban populations, between IDP and non-IDP populations, and between men and women in Somalia are striking. It's noteworthy, for example, that Somalia is the only country in the world where there is a rural and urban gap of more than 50 percentage points in access to a basic water supply (WHO and UNICEF 2019). A survey in Somaliland found that approximately 60 percent of households relied on adult women to collect water (UNICEF 2011). Women who travel away from their residences to obtain water can risk their personal safety, with gender-based violence high in rural and nom adic areas in the country (MoEWR 2021). Urban areas have grown over the last decades, increasing the demand for water by households and businesses. It is estimated that approximately 54 percent of Somalia's population now live in urban areas (World Bank 2021a). In cities, piped networks, point-source vendors at boreholes and dug wells, as well as truckers and animal and human-drawn carters deliver water to consumers.

| Table 3: *An analysis of relevant Policies, Studies and Guidelines.*

18 Somalia National Water Resource Strategy, 2021 - 2025

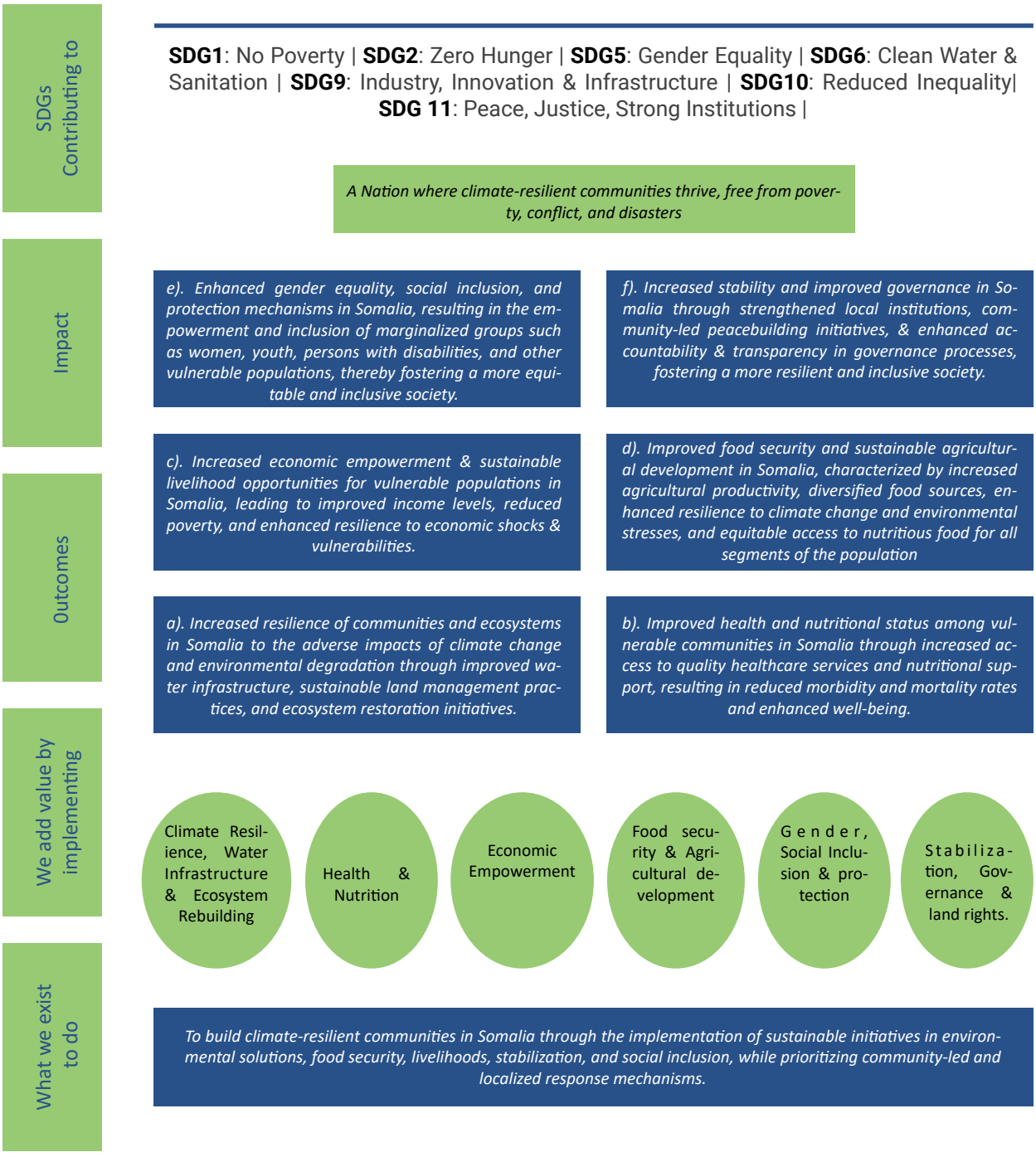


| ***Figure 7***: *Beneficiaries building river embankment through Cahs for Work (CFW) to prevent flooding in Beledweyne.*

Theory of Change

In the humanitarian sector, where challenges are numerous and changing, having a clear direction is critical. Our ToC serves as a compass, illuminating the path ahead in the face of uncertainty and enabling us to navigate complexities with purpose and effectiveness. Our strategy is founded on the understanding that change is not a linear process, but rather a complex web of actions, reactions, and adaptations. We aim to catalyze positive cascades of change through strategic interventions informed by empirical evidence and local context, resulting in an impact far greater than the sum of its parts and enlisting the various SDGs to which our strategy contributes. The following is a diagrammatic representation of our ToC:

| ***Figure 8:*** *SYPD Theory of Change*



Dependencies, Assumptions, Risks and Mitigation Strategies.

Key assumptions and dependencies

The following key assumptions were made while developing this strategy for 2024-2028:
Sustained Financial Support| We anticipate continuous financial backing from our existing network of partners and donors, believing in their ongoing commitment to our mission. This assumption is grounded in the strength of our past collaborations and the alignment of our future goals with their funding priorities. It acknowledges the importance of sustained investment to achieve long-term impact.

Fostering Strong Relationships | We expect to maintain and enhance positive relationships with our partners and donors, based on mutual respect, shared goals, and open communication. This includes a commitment to transparency, regular engagement, and collaborative problem-solving, ensuring these partnerships remain robust and productive.

Harmonious Community Relations | Our strategy assumes that we will continue to foster and benefit from positive and cooperative relationships within the communities we serve in Somalia. This includes a belief in the ongoing willingness of host communities to engage with and support our initiatives, based on trust and mutual benefit, facilitating the smooth implementation of our programs.

Socio-economic and Political Stability | The assumption of relative socio-economic and political stability within Somalia over the strategic period underpins our planning. This stability is crucial for the uninterrupted execution of our initiatives and for creating an environment conducive to sustainable development and progress.

Consistency in Development Partners' Policies | We assume that there will be no significant shifts in the policy or focus areas of our development partners that could affect our strategic priorities or resource allocation. This stability is essential for strategic alignment and the effective planning and execution of our long-term initiatives.

Regulatory Environment Stability | We operate under the assumption that the regulatory environment within which we work will remain stable, without any major changes that could impact our strategic direction or operational capacity. This predictability is crucial for ensuring that our strategies remain relevant and effective over the next five years.

Risks and Mitigation Strategies

Risks' likelihood and impact can be categorized as high, medium, or low. High risks are catastrophic, may jeopardize SYPD's existence, and must be monitored at the board level. Medium is a second-tier risk of material significance that has the potential to cause significant financial or reputational harm and should be managed expressly by the Executive Director (ED) and reported to the board. Low-risk decisions have little impact and are delegated to management team during periodic board reviews.

Risk Category	Possible Risk	Mitigation Strategy
Strategic Risk	- Incoherence of organization vision and the strategies. - Inability to implement the strategy in line with the set-out objectives - Reputational damage due to ethical lapses, misconduct - Strategic alliances or partnerships failing to deliver expected results.	- Staff induction into the current strategy-2024-2028. - Midterm and end term evaluations. - Prioritize ethical conduct, transparency, and accountability in all organizational activities. - Before building strategic alliances or partnerships, conduct comprehensive due diligence and risk assessments.
Operational Risk	- Key Staff exits - Breakdown of systems - Fraud - Organizational change - Supply chain disruptions	- Improve HR policies to cater for staff motivation through objective and merit-based performance reward system. - Improved financial management controls (More approval levels). - Develop and operationalize change management plan (strategies). - Develop a programs implementation guidelines to guide all program operations. - Develop succession plans and cross-training initiatives that mitigate the impact of key personnel turnover while ensuring operational continuity.
Financial Risk	- High projects burn rate compared to project performance. - Currency fluctuations - Budget overruns	- Ensure that the project team and finance team conduct regular reviews, preferably quarterly, to track the burn rate(s). - Implement robust financial planning and budgeting processes to forecast cash flow, monitor expenses, and manage financial resources effectively. - Monitor and manage currency risks through hedging strategies, foreign exchange contracts, or diversification of investments to mitigate exposure to exchange rate fluctuations. - Diversify revenue streams and maintain adequate reserves to cushion against financial shocks and economic downturns.
Technological Risk	- Inability to keep pace with changing technological landscape - Staff inability to cope with the changes in technologies. - IT systems failure	- Planning for staff capacity building in response to emerging technological trends. - Adopting/acquiring latest project management and other MIS(s) for effective and efficient organizational processes. - Backup critical data on a regular basis and store it securely off-site or in the cloud.

| ***Table 4:*** *Risks and Mitigation Strategies*

We will develop and put into effect a risk management framework to help us continuously assess and manage risks that may impact the strategic plan's delivery in 2024-2028. SYPD will implement both preventive and detective controls to reduce the risks. Other measures will include staff training in risk management, risk identification and profiling, monitoring and response/mitigation, linking the risk management framework to the strategy, and developing an action plan.

Corporate Governance and Role of The Board

The current SYPD board consists of five (5) members who meet twice a year to discuss the organization's performance and provide support as needed. During this strategic period, we will put in place a governance system to ensure that employees, directors, and management all have equal rights, relationships, roles, and responsibilities. This ensures that delivery is founded on integrity, professionalism, dedication, sustainability, inclusivity, and innovation.

The Board of Directors will: -

- Provide technical oversight and direction.
- Support resource mobilization.
- Ensure compliance with plans and service to those we serve.
- Ensure effective and efficient performance.

Detailed Roles of the Board

	Area	Functions
1	Organizational Leadership Strengthening	• Performance Management of the executive • Mentor and guide the executive. • Strategic Planning, monitoring, and evaluation • Organizational external evaluation
2	Performance Management	• Establish suitable indicators for organizational performance. • Monitor organizational performance regularly. • Strategic guidance on organizational growth
3	Strategy Setting and Management	• Develop organizational goals, vision, and mission. • Manage strategy implementation. • Guide on organizational strategic directions
4	Risk Management	• Strategic guidance on organizational risks management • Overall management of organizational risks
5	Compliance	• Ensure organizational compliance to partners/donors' requirements. • Ensure organizational compliance with the strategies. • Ensure compliance with regulatory frameworks
6	Operating Plan	• Provide leadership to the organizational operational plans. • Set policy agenda for the organization
7	Partnerships Management and Communication	• Lead in strategic organizational communication. • Increase organizational market share. • Enhance organizational partnership management

| ***Table 5**: Detailed role of the Board*

The role of Management

During this strategic period, management will play an array of important roles to ensure that the strategy is implemented successfully. The SYPD management will play several important roles in this process, as outlined below:

Strategic Planning | The SYPD Management will be leading this strategic planning process, engaging key stakeholders, setting priorities, and allocating resources to support strategic pillars identified.

Resource Allocation | Management will allocate financial, human, and material resources to support the implementation of strategic pillars. They will prioritize funds received, approve budgets, and ensure that resources are utilized effectively to achieve the organizational objectives and deliver measurable results.

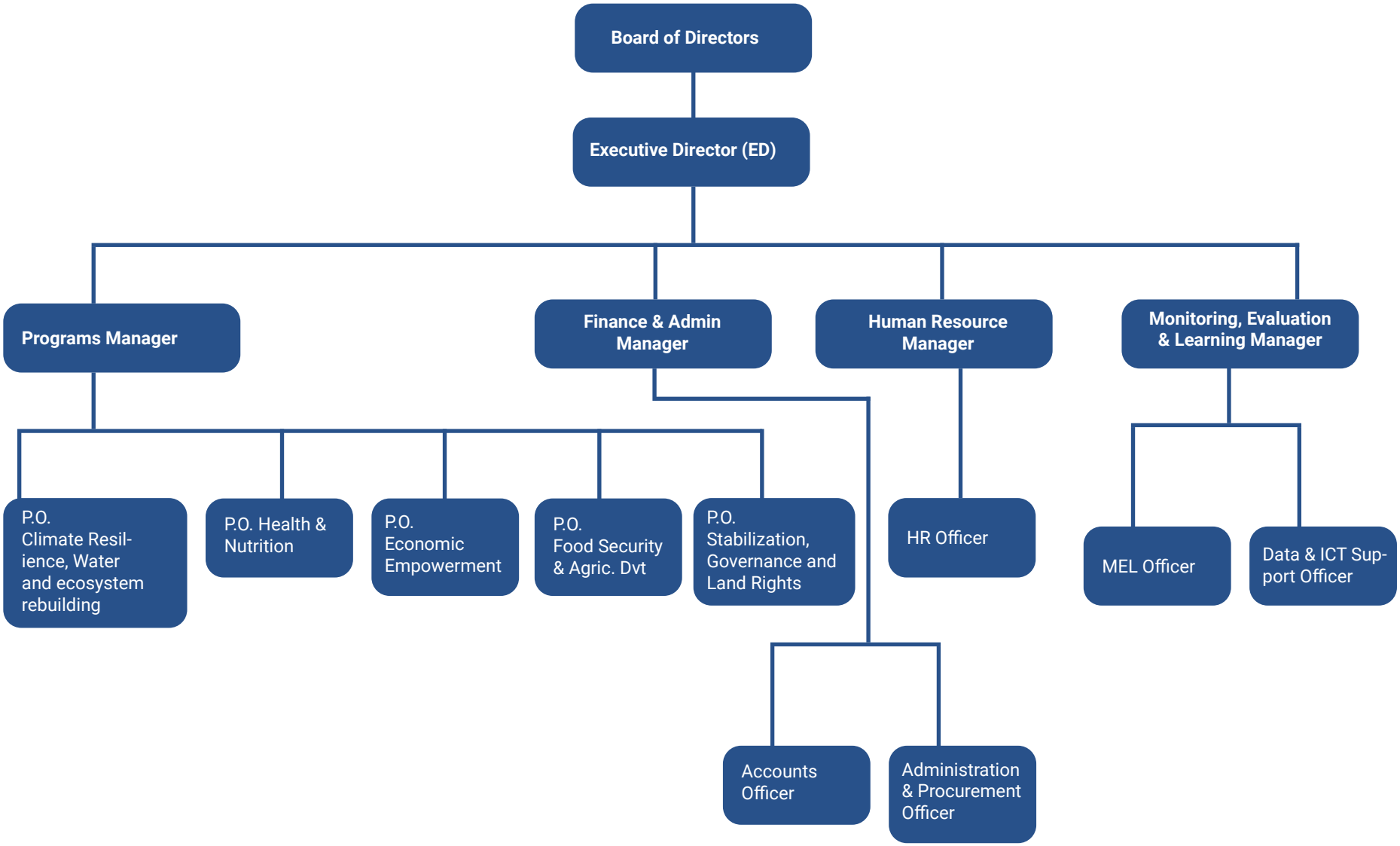
Organizational Alignment | Management will align the organization's structure, systems, processes, and culture with the strategic pillars outlined in the plan. They will communicate the strategic direction to staff, define roles and responsibilities, and foster an atmosphere of accountability, collaboration, and innovation.

Stakeholder Engagement | Management will engage with internal and external stakeholders, such as staff, program beneficiaries, implementing partners (local and national actors), donors, INGOs, and the Somali government, to foster relationships, gather feedback, and gain support for the strategic plan's implementation. Their primary responsibility will be to communicate specific project or program progress as well as organizational progress, address concerns, and foster trust and confidence in the organization's ability to deliver on its promises.

Leadership and Change Management | SYPD Management will provide leadership and guidance to inspire staff, motivate teams, and drive change across the organization. They will be expected to create an environment conducive to innovation, promote continuous learning and improvement, and promote for the strategic plan's goals.



Organogram


Board of Directors
Executive Director (ED)
Programs Manager
Finance & Admin Manager
Human Resource Manager
Monitoring, Evaluation & Learning Manager
P.O. Climate Resil-ience, Water and ecosystem rebuilding
P.O. Health & Nutrition
P.O. Economic Empowerment
P.O. Food Security & Agric. Dvt
P.O. Stabilization, Governance and Land Rights
HR Officer
MEL Officer
Data & ICT Sup-port Officer
Accounts Officer
Administration & Procurement Officer

Resource Mobilization Plan

SYPD has a well-defined resource mobilization strategy which entails both managing current resources within the organization and pursuing additional resources as needed. The objective of this campaign is *"to grow SYPD's diversified funding sources and financial resilience by securing **USD 14, 486,084.00** million in grants, emergency relief and support, partnerships, and retention of current donors for the next five years."*

SYPD is currently implementing seven (7) projects funded by WHH, DKH, IOM, and Appeal USA, totaling more than **2.1 million dollars.** The table below summarizes the various strategies and targets that SYPD will use to mobilize resources over the next five years.

Strategy	Initiatives	Weighting (%)	Measure	Annual Targets (in USD)					Cumulative Target (in USD)
				2024	2025	2026	2027	2028	
Source and submit Grant Proposals and Applications	International NGOs and Donors	79%	Value of grants received in USD from INGOs	1,164,500.00	2,411,500.00	2,185,084.00	3,178,000.00	2,565,000.00	**11,504,084.00**
	Foundations	1%	Value of Grants received in USD from Foundations	20,000.00	28,000.00	27,000.00	24,000.00	28,000.00	**127,000.00**
Emergency Relief Grants and Rapid Response Funding		20%	Value of support received in USD through emergency relief grants and response funding.	350,000.00	785,000.00	460,000.00	760,000.00	500,000.00	**2,855,000.00**
Totals		**100%**		**1,534,500.00**	**3,224,500.00**	**2,672,084.00**	**3,962,000.00**	**3,093,000.00**	**14,486,084.00**

Table 6: *SYPD Resource Mobilization Estimates for the next 5 years.*

Communication Plan

The communication plan for SYPD in the next strategic period will serve as a roadmap for effectively communicating the organization's mission, values, activities, and impact to various stakeholders, including donors, partners, beneficiaries, and the general public. The objective of this plan will *be "To enhance awareness and visibility of SYPD's work in Somalia among the key stakeholders through increased engagements, and amplification of the impact of our programs through strategic communication efforts."* Below is the communication plan outlining the individuals responsible for conveying messages to specific audiences or stakeholders, providing details on the who, what, how, and when of communication.

	Audience	Message Type	Delivery Method	Schedule	Message Source
Internal	Staff	Organizational activities, events, and important announcements.	Email, Internal messaging platform (Official WhatsApp platform) or intranet system.	Weekly, monthly, bi-monthly	ED/CEO, Manager(s).
	Management	Strategic Updates- organizational goals, strategic initiatives, and progress towards targets. Decision-Making Communication- important decisions, policy changes, and strategic directions to management staff.	Meetings- in person or virtual. Memos- formal written memos or briefs via email or internal communication channels for documentation and reference.	Strategic Updates-Monthly. Decision-Making Communication- memos sent out within 48 hours of a decision being made.	ED/CEO
	Board Members	Quarterly Reports- financial performance, program achievements, and strategic initiatives. Meeting Agendas Strategic Updates- strategic direction, goals, and important developments to ensure alignment with the board's vision and priorities.	Email, postal mail,	Quarterly Reports: Sent out at the end of each fiscal quarter, within one week after the financial reporting period. Meeting Agendas: Distributed one week prior to scheduled board meetings to allow sufficient time for review. Strategic Updates: Provided as needed, with a goal of communicating major strategic shifts or updates at least biannually.	Chairperson of the Board or the ED/CEO

	Audience	Message Type	Delivery Method	Schedule	Message Source
External	Donors and INGOs	Project Updates- progress reports and updates on ongoing projects, including achievements, challenges, and impact. Funding Requests- Sending requests for financial support or grants for specific projects or initiatives.	Email Newsletter- regular newsletters via email to donors and INGOs, containing project updates, success stories. Virtual Meetings/Webinars: Organizing virtual meetings or webinars to engage donors and INGOs directly, share updates, and discuss collaboration opportunities.	Monthly Email Newsletters Quarterly or bi-annual Virtual Meetings/Webinars	Communications Manager or ED/ CEO
	Local Government and Agencies	Collaboration Invitation on specific projects or initiatives. Progress Update on activities, achievements, and impact within the communities.	Formal Letters addressed to relevant government officials & agency representatives. In-person Meetings (face-to-face or briefings) with key stakeholders to discuss collaboration opportunities & progress updates.	Collaboration invitations when new projects or initiatives are being planned. Progress updates quarterly or semi-annually, depending on project timelines and stakeholder preferences.	The Project Coordinator or Program Manager.
	Local and National Actors/Peer Organizations	Collaborative Opportunities- potential collaboration projects, partnerships, or joint initiatives. Knowledge Sharing- research findings, best practices, & lessons learned in the field of work. Advocacy Updates- Advocacy efforts, policy changes, & relevant news affecting the sector. Networking Events- conferences, workshops, or networking events aimed at fostering connections & sharing experiences.	Emails, Online Platforms (e.g. social media). Direct Communication-one-on-one or group meetings, phone calls, or virtual conferences.	Collaborative Opportunities- quarterly basis. Knowledge Sharing-Monthly or bi-monthly, depending on the availability of new insights and findings. Advocacy Updates- As developments occur or on a bi-weekly basis. Networking Events- Announcements will be made in advance of events, with reminders closer to the date.	Communications Manager
	Corporates and other development Partners in the region	Partnership Updates- ongoing projects, achievements, and impact stories. Collaboration Opportunities- potential collaboration opportunities, partnership initiatives, & areas for joint projects or funding opportunities.	Email Newsletters Virtual Meetings/Webinars	Monthly Email Newsletters Quarterly Virtual Meetings/Webinars	The Head of Partnerships or Communications Manager

Audience	Message Type	Delivery Method	Schedule	Message Source
Local Communities	Public Awareness Messages- Providing information on health, hygiene, education, and other relevant topics to promote community well-being. Community Engagement Messages-Encouraging participation in community development projects, initiatives, and events.	Community Meetings- Conducting regular face-to-face meetings in local villages and communities to deliver messages directly. Radio Broadcasts- Utilizing local radio stations to reach a wider audience with pre-recorded or live messages broadcasted at scheduled times.	Bi-weekly community Meetings. Weekly radio Broadcasts.	The persons in charge of community outreach at SYPD will serve as the primary communicator for messages to local communities, ensuring cultural sensitivity, effective communication, and community engagement.
Who?	What?	How?	When?	Person Responsible

Table 7: SYPD Communication plan

M&E Activities workplan

We will ensure strategy institutionalization and supervisory oversight, program and project implementation surveys, quarterly review meetings, and evaluations that will include mid-term evaluations and reviews (MTER), end-of-term evaluations, and annual strategic performance reviews for management and the board.

Activity	2024				2025				2026				2027				2028			
	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
In-House Staff & Board Feedback (monthly)	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√
Quarterly Reviews by Mgt Board	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√
Quarterly Assessment of staff performance	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√
Annual External Audits	√				√				√				√				√			
Provision of progress report to strategic partners (Quarterly)	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√	√
Midterm review										√										
Strategic Review and End of Term Review																			√	
Review and Preparation of the strategic plan (2029-2033)																				√

| ***Table 8:*** M&E Activities workplan

Our Partners



SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT &
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